

State of the Web 2020–2025

HTTP Archive Trends in Page Weight, Protocols, and Security

Data Source: HTTP Archive — State of the Web Report | Time Range: Jan 2020 – Mar 2026

For web performance engineers & front-end architects evaluating infrastructure trends

Crawl Sample Size Tripled: From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020

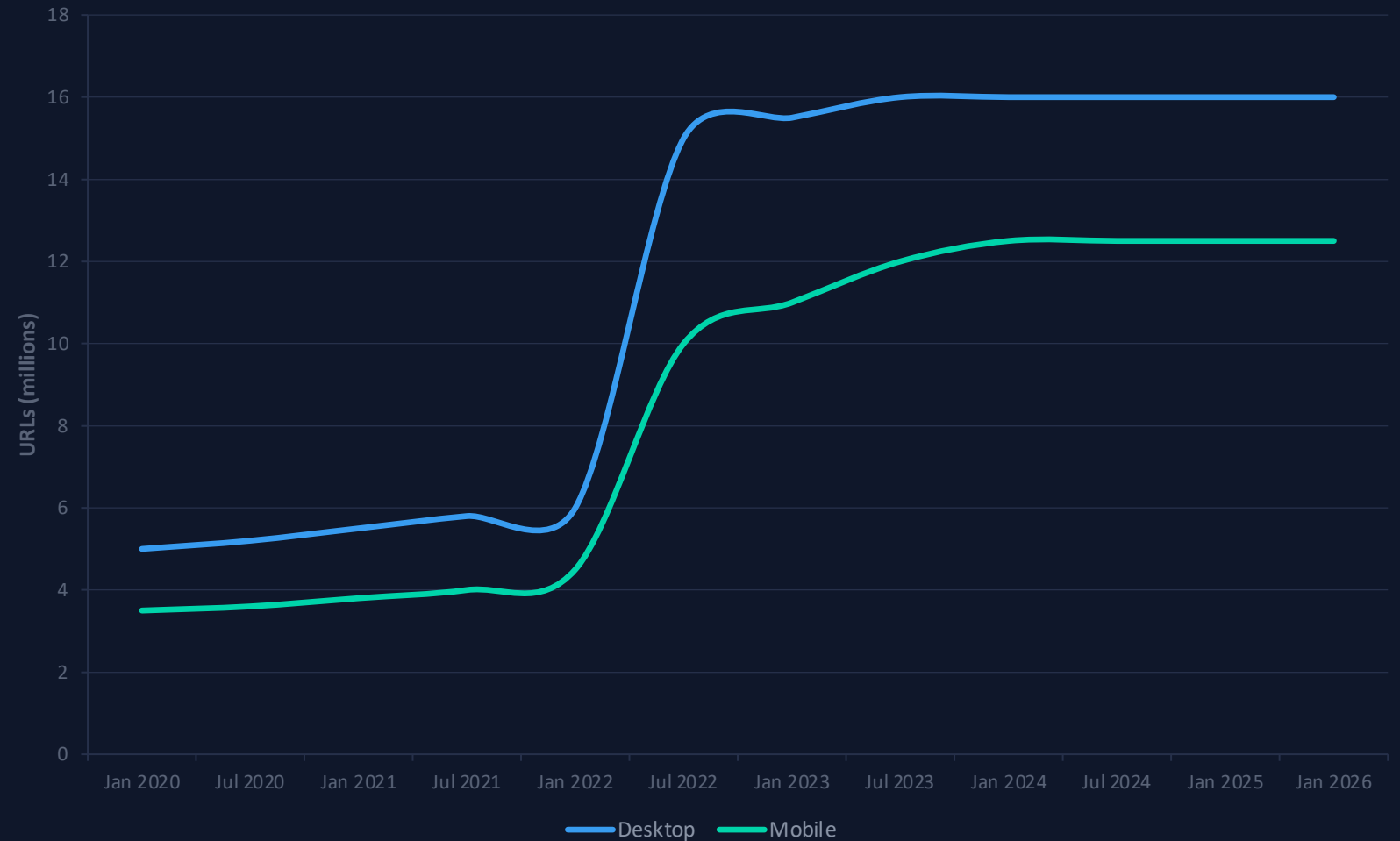
Desktop URLs

16M (was ~5M in 2020)

Mobile URLs

12.5M (was ~3.5M in 2020)

Sharp jump in mid-2022 when the crawl expanded. Both desktop and mobile have stabilized near their current levels since mid-2023.

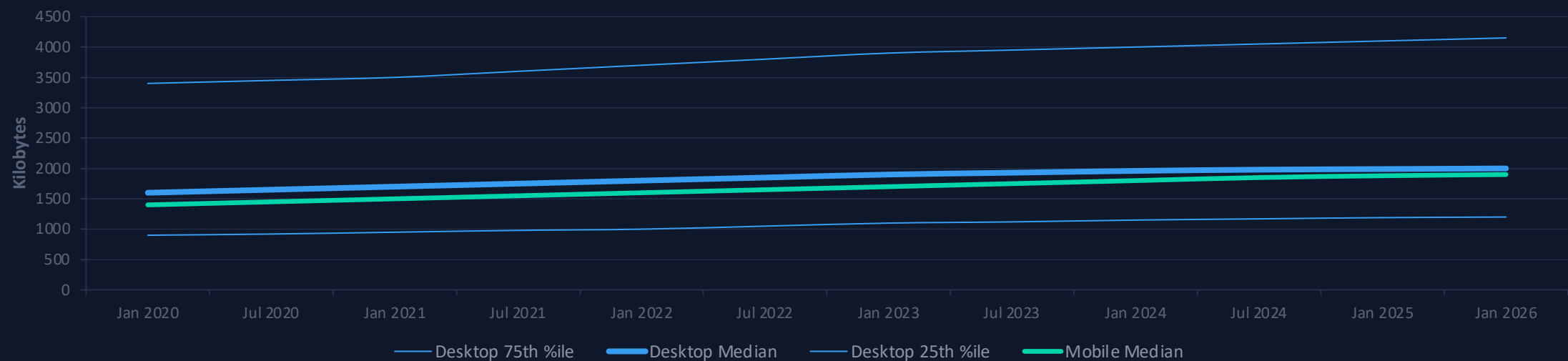


Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily to ~2,000 KB on Desktop

Desktop median: **~2,000 KB** ▲ 25% since 2020

Mobile median: **~1,900 KB** ▲ 25% since 2020

75th-percentile desktop page exceeds 4,000 KB — long tail of heavy pages



76 Requests per Desktop Page While TCP Connections Drop to 12

REQUESTS PER PAGE

Desktop

76

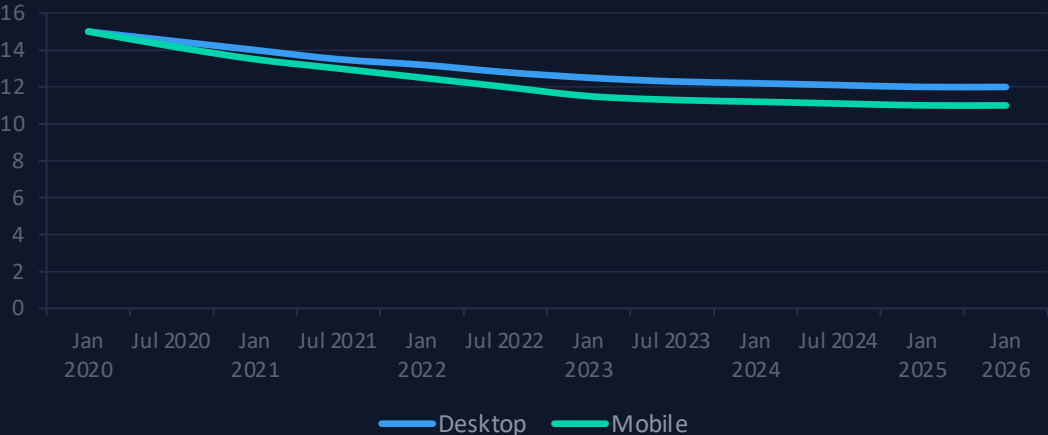
▲ 2.7% since 2020

Mobile

71

▲ 2.9% since 2020

TCP CONNECTIONS PER PAGE (DECLINING)



Efficiency Gains from Multiplexing

Desktop connections fell 14.3% (15 → 12)

Mobile connections fell 26.7% (15 → 11)

Despite 3% more requests per page, HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 multiplexing allow many requests over fewer TCP connections.

Desktop

▼ 14.3%

Mobile

▼ 26.7%

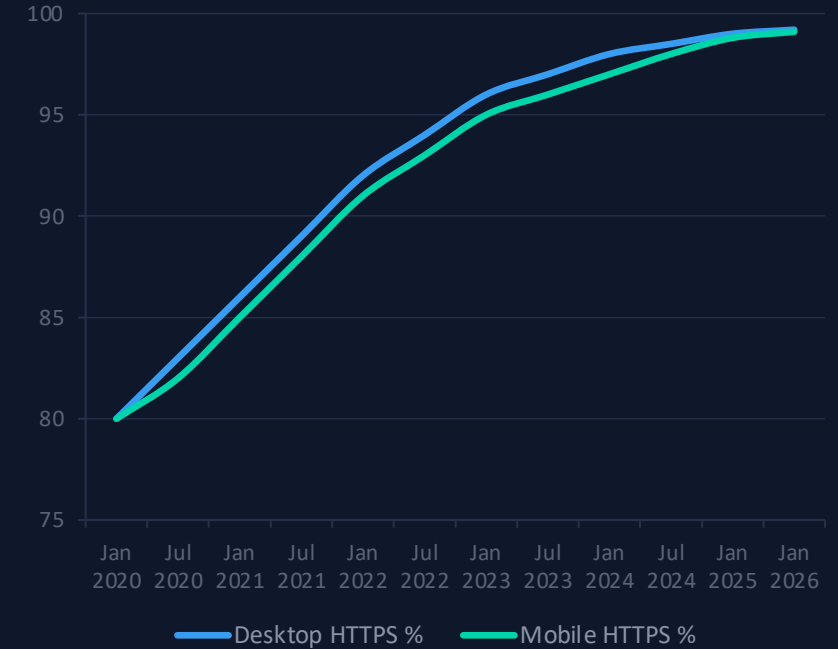
HTTPS Requests Reach 99%: Encryption Is Now the Default

HTTPS ADOPTION

99%+

Desktop: 99.2% Mobile: 99.1%

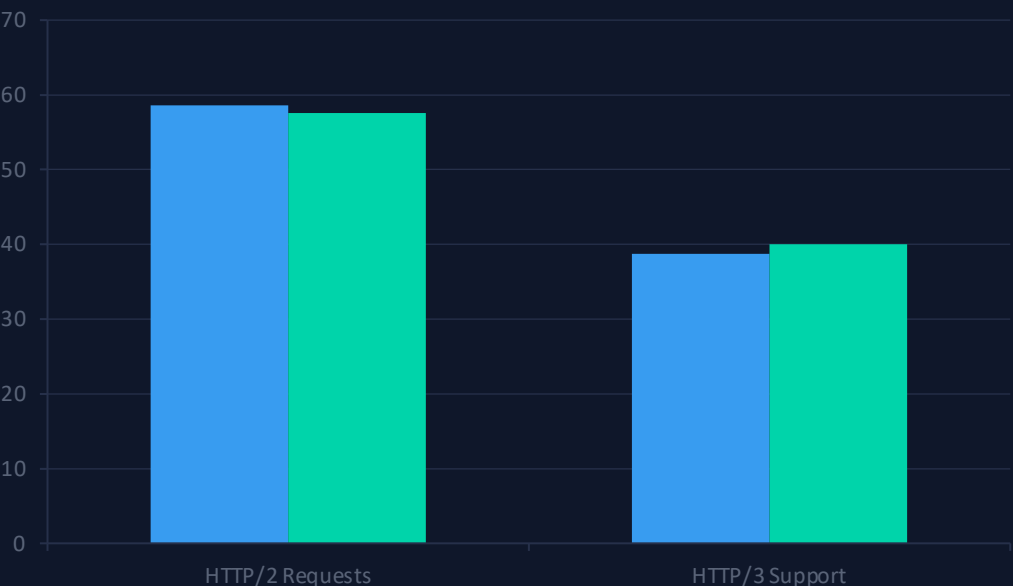
▲ ~19–20 percentage points since 2020 (from ~80%)



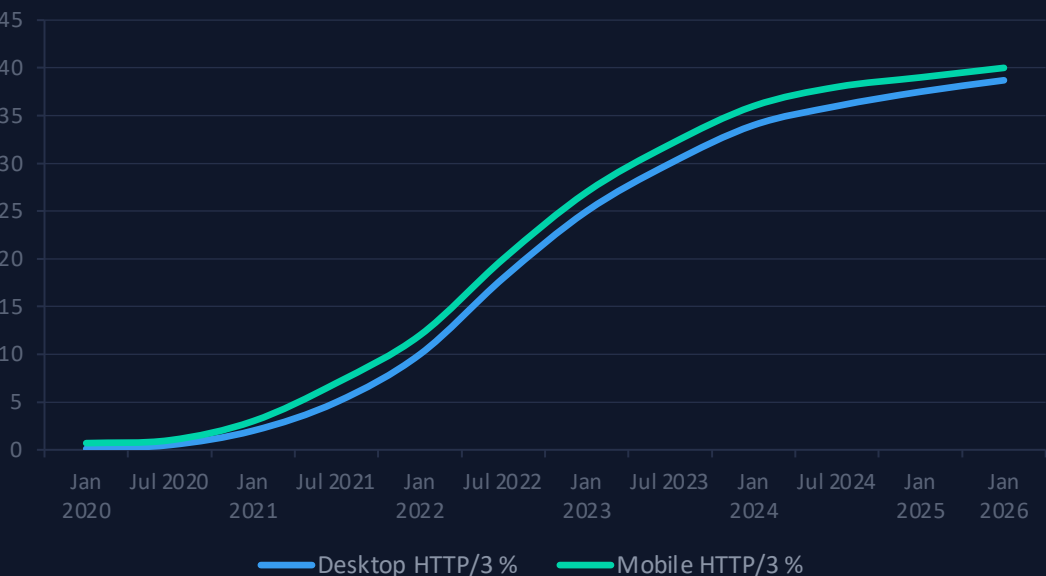
Plaintext HTTP is effectively extinct on the modern web. Unencrypted requests now account for less than 1% of all traffic.

HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%

CURRENT PROTOCOL SHARE



HTTP/3 SUPPORT GROWTH (FROM NEAR-ZERO)



Measurement Note

HTTP Archive measures HTTP/3 support rather than actual usage. Fresh Chrome instances default to HTTP/2 on first connection before discovering HTTP/3 capability via Alt-Svc headers. HTTP/2 growth is modest (1–3%) partly because HTTP/3 is absorbing newer adoption. Desktop HTTP/3 support rose 38,600% and mobile 5,614% from near-zero baselines.

Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile, Up 61% Since 2020

Desktop

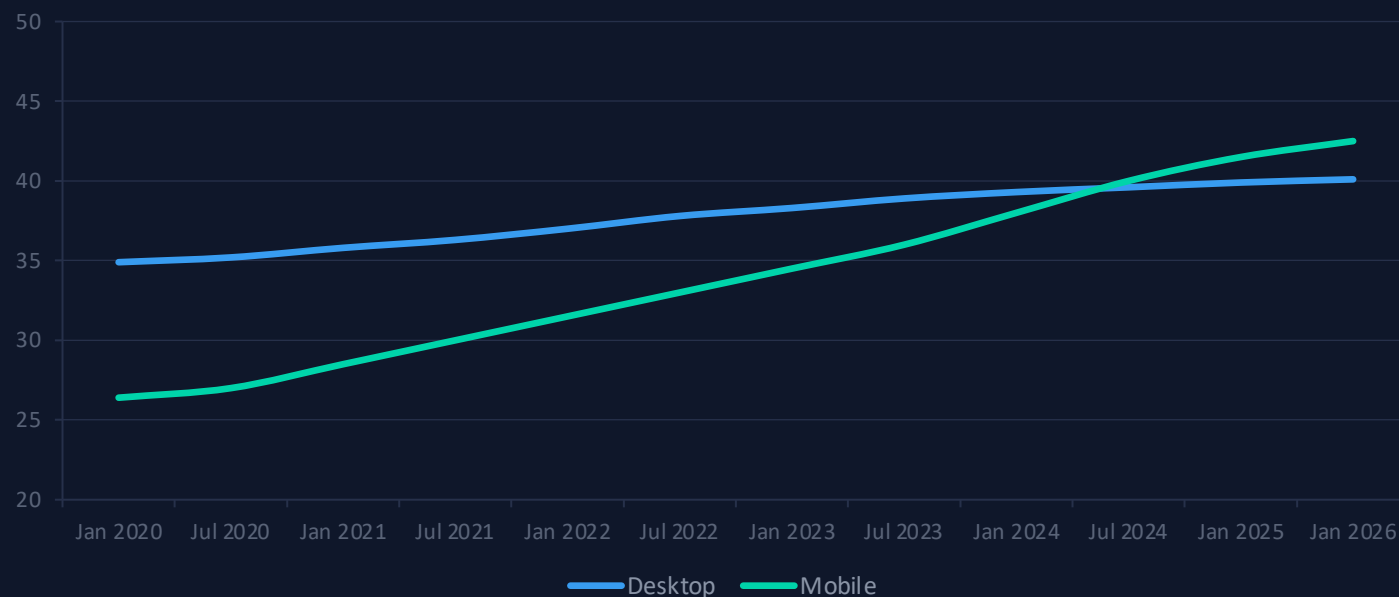
40.1%

▲ 14.9% since 2020

Mobile

42.5%

▲ 61.0% since 2020



Why font-display Matters

The font-display CSS property controls how web fonts are rendered during loading, avoiding the Flash of Invisible Text (FOIT).

With >50% of pages still not using font-display, there is significant room for improvement in perceived load performance.

Key Takeaways: Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

01

Page Weight Keeps Climbing

Median desktop pages now transfer ~2,000 KB, roughly 25% heavier than 2020, driven by richer media and JavaScript.

02

HTTPS Is the New Baseline

At 99%+ of requests, unencrypted HTTP is essentially extinct on the modern web.

03

HTTP/3: Fastest-Growing Protocol Metric

From near-zero to ~40% support in under four years, HTTP/3 is rapidly becoming mainstream.

04

Fewer Connections Despite More Requests

Multiplexing in HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 cut median TCP connections per page by 15–27%, improving network efficiency.

05

Font-Display Still Underused

At ~40–42% adoption, more than half of pages still risk FOIT — significant room for improvement.

Benchmark your own sites against these baselines → httparchive.org/reports/state-of-the-web